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Lesson 44 Patterns of culture

文化的模式 宾语从句 状语从句

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commonplace / ˈkɒmənpleɪs / adj. 平凡的
trivial / ˈtrɪviəl / adj. 微不足道的，琐细的

manifest / ˈmænɪfest / v. 表明
stereotype / ˈsteriətaɪp / n. 陈规
accommodation / əˌkɒməˈdeɪʃ(ə)n / n. 适应

preliminary / prɪˈlɪmɪnəri / adj. 初步的
controversial / ˌkɒntrəˈvɜːʃ(ə)l / adj. 引起争论的
termite / ˈtɜːmaɪt / n. 白蚁
variant / ˈveəriənt / n. 不同的
pagan / ˈpeɪgən / n. 异教徒
premise / ˈpremɪs / n. 前提

preferential / ˌprefəˈrenʃ(ə)l / adj. 优先的

aberrant / əˈberənt / adj. 脱离常轨的，异常的
predominant / prɪˈdɒmɪnənt / adj. 占优势的，起支配作用的
pristine / ˈprɪstiːn / adj. 纯洁的，质朴的
vernacular / vəˈnækjələ(r) / n. 方言
incumbent / ɪnˈkʌmbənt / adj. 义不容辞的，有责任的
proposition / ˌprɒpəˈzɪʃ(ə)n / n. 主张
cactus / ˈkæktəs / n. 仙人掌

nebula / ˈnebjələ / adj. 星云
barbarian / bɑːˈbeəriən / n. 野蛮人
sophistication / səˌfɪstɪˈkeɪʃn / n. 老练
supernatural / ˌsuːpəˈnætʃrəl; ˌsjuːpəˈnætʃrəl / adj. 超自然的

论点 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-15 12:55:44)

※ Custom has not commonly been regarded as a subject of any great moment.

『commonly adj. usually; widely 通常；广泛地』

- The disease is **commonly** known as mad cow disease.
- a **commonly** used industrial chemical

- A little adolescent rebellion is **commonly** believed to be healthy. 少许青春期叛逆被普遍认为是一个健康的现象。

『 **moment** n. outstanding significance or value, importance 重要(古英语) 』

- a discovery of great **moment**
- The minor disagreement was not considered a subject **of any great moment** by the diplomats. 外交官们认为这个小小的分歧不具备任何重大意义。

of great moment 非常重要的；重大的	The discovery of a new energy source is an event **of great moment** for the entire world. 发现一种新资源是对全世界而言都影响深远的重大事件。

『 **momentous** adj. vital, crucial, key, critical 重要的，重大的，关键的 』

- We also face a **momentous** choice. 我们面对着重大抉择。
- Last year was awful but **momentous**. 去年是糟糕的一年，但也具有重大意义。
- The second order is more **momentous**. 第二项指令则更加声势浩大。

※ The inner workings of our own brains we feel to be uniquely worthy of investigation, but custom, we have a way of thinking, is behaviour at its most commonplace.

The inner workings of our own brains	we	feel	to be uniquely worthy of investigation	but custom,...
宾语前置（为了强调宾语）	主语	谓动	宾语补足语	并列句

『 **the workings of sth.** the way that an organization, machine or organism operates 工作方式，运作方式，运转方式 』

- **the workings of** government
- **the workings of** a car engine
- Our bodies play a bigger role in **the workings of** the mind than we ever knew. 我们的身体对大脑的影响远比我们知道的要多。

> We feel **the inner workings of our brains** to be uniquely worthy of investigation, ... 正常语序

『 **宾语前置**（为了强调宾语的重要性） 』

- **Smoking** he absolutely loathes.
- **That John is a thief** I can't believe.
- The president praised the loyalists, but **the rebels** he declared traitors.

> 不患人之不**己**知 患不知人也
> 硕鼠硕鼠 无食我黍 三岁贯女 莫**我**肯顾
> 微斯人 吾**谁**与归

『 **宾语后置**（因宾语太长，先说状语） 』

- He has **proved** them wrong. ⇒ He has proved wrong the forecasts made by the country's leading economic experts.
- In 1928 some porpoises were photographed working like beavers to **push** ashore a waterlogged mattress.
- It has to be tall because it is like a giant block and tackle, and we have to **lower** into the ground and **haul** out of the ground **great lengths of drill pipe which are rotated by an engine at the top and are fitted with a cutting bit at the bottom**.

『 **be worthy of n./doing** 值得...；配得上... 』

- His dedicated service is **worthy of** the highest praise. 他的敬业服务值得最高赞誉。
- Your diligence **is worthy of** encouragement, but effort does not equal accomplishment. 你的勤奋值得鼓励，但努力不等于成就。
- The bank might think you**'re worthy of** a loan. 这家银行可能认为你应该得到一笔贷款。

be worthy to do / to be done 值得去做 / 值得被做	• ... to be uniquely **worthy to be investigated** ... 本文替换 • The problem is **worthy to be** considered more carefully. 这个问题值得更仔细地考虑。
be worth + n. / doing 值得... （后面接动名词主动形式表示被动意义）	• ... to **be** uniquely **worth** investigation ... • ... to **be** uniquely **worth** investigating ... 要用主动 • This book is worthy of being read [to be read]. 这本书值得一读。 • This classic film is **worth** watching several times. 这部经典电影值得看好几次。

『 **have a way of doing sth.** often or usually do sth. 往往，常常 』

- Ruth **has a way of** ignoring me that drives me mad.
- That critical spirit **has a way of** boomeranging. 那种批评的精神会使你自食其果。
- Life **has a way of** throwing these curve balls at us. 生活用它自己的方式不断向我们抛出曲线球。

> ..., we usually think, ... 本文替换 have a way of ..

『 **commonplace** adj. happening or existing in many places, and therefore not special or unusual 寻常的，司空见惯的，不足为奇的 』

- All these computer uses have become **commonplace**.

- Eating three meals a day is considered behaviour at its most **commonplace** in many cultures.在许多文化中，一天吃三餐被认为是行为中最平常无奇的。

『**at one's + 形容词最高级** 处于...最...的状态』

- At the age of twelve years, the human body is **at its most vigorous**.
- The garden is **at its most beautiful** in June.
- Caesar was **at his most powerful** when he conquered Gaul.

※ As a matter of fact, it is the other way around.

『**the other way around / round** 情况恰恰相反』

- I thought he was the boss and she was his secretary, but in fact **it was the other way around**.
- I don't help him; it's **the other way around**—he helps me. 不是我帮他；正相反，是他帮我。
- Most people think the boss helps the employees, but in this company, **it is the other way around**.大多数人认为老板帮助员工，但在这家公司，情况恰恰相反。

the opposite n. 相反的人或物；对立面	• The other side of the picture is quite **the opposite**. • I thought the exam would be difficult, but quite **the opposite** was true. 我原以为考试会很难，但事实恰恰相反。
the contrary n.相反;反之;正相反;反而	I was worried that it might be too difficult for me but I found **the contrary**.
the reverse n. & adj. 相反（的）；反面	• The teachers say my son is slow, but I believe **the reverse**. • The results of the second test were **the reverse** of the first. 第二次测试的结果与第一次完全相反。
the antithesis n. 对立面；对照（通常指极端的对立）	• She is slim and shy—**the very antithesis** of her sister. • His lifestyle is **the antithesis** of his parents' frugal habits. 他的生活方式与他父母勤俭节约的习惯完全背道而驰。

※ Traditional custom, taken the world over, is a mass of detailed behaviour more astonishing than what any one person can ever evolve in individual actions, no matter how aberrant.

『**the world over** 在全世界；遍及全球』

- Football is a sport that is loved by millions **the world over**. 足球是一项深受全世界数百万人喜爱的运动。
- The impact of climate change, **taken the world over**, is undeniable.气候变化的影响，从全世界来看，是不可否认的。

all over the world 世界各地；全世界	They have branches in almost every major city **all over the world**. 他们在几乎全世界的每个主要城市都设有分支机构。
throughout the world 遍及全世界	The news of the discovery spread rapidly **throughout the world**. 这一发现的消息迅速传遍了全世界。
around the world 环绕世界；在世界各处	She traveled **around the world** to document different cultural traditions. 她环游世界，记录不同的文化传统。

『 **a mass of... / masses of...** 大量的；大块的；一堆 』

- This caused the construction of gigantic buildings where **too large masses of** human beings are crowded together.
- The star appeared as **a mass of** burning gas in the telescope. 这颗恒星在望远镜中呈现为一团燃烧的气体。
- He has **masses of** work to do before the weekend. 周末前他有大量的工作要做。
- The complex ritual involved **a mass of** detailed behaviour that had to be followed precisely.复杂的仪式涉及一堆必须精确遵循的细节行为。

a lot of... / lots of... 许多；大量	• There are **a lot of** people waiting outside the theater. 剧院外有许多人在等候。 • We had **lots of** fun at the beach yesterday. 昨天我们在海滩玩得很开心。

『 **evolve** v. to develop and change gradually 演变 』

- Popular music **evolved from** folk songs.
- The group gradually **evolved into** a political party.
- Animals have **evolved** camouflage to protect themselves from predators.

evolution n.进化；演变	Darwin’s theory of **evolution**
字根 “volve” 表：转	• ev**olve** in**volve** re**volve** • **The earth revolves around the sun.**

『 **aberrant** adj. abnormal 异常的 』

- Taking drugs may result in **aberrant** behavior.
- The leader remained calm, **no matter how aberrant** the team's suggestions became.这位领导者保持冷静，无论团队的建议变得多么反常。
- **Aberrant behaviour**, often brought on by boredom, is not unusual in zoo animals. 在动物园里，类似的异常行为并不罕见。

※ Yet that is a rather trivial aspect of the matter.

『**trivial** adj. not serious, important, or valuable 微不足道的』

- I know it sounds **trivial**, but I'm worried about it.
- The cost was considered **a rather trivial aspect** compared to the overall safety benefits.与整体安全效益相比，成本被认为是一个相当微不足道的方面。

a trivial detail 细枝末节；微不足道的细节	Don't let **a trivial detail** distract you from the main objective of the project. 不要让微不足道的细节分散你对项目主要目标的注意力。
a trivial matter / problem 琐事；无足轻重的问题	In the grand scheme of things, whether we choose blue or green is **a trivial matter**. 从大局来看，选择蓝色还是绿色只是件琐事。

※ The fact of first-rate importance is the predominant role that custom plays in experience and in belief, and the very great varieties it may manifest.

『**of ... importance** （具有）...重要性的』

- The cultivation of a hobby and new forms of interest is therefore a policy **of the first importance** to a public man.
- The security of user data is **of paramount importance** to our company. 用户数据的安全对我们公司来说至关重要。

『**play a ... role / part in ...** 在...中起...作用/扮演...角色』

- Education **plays a vital role in** shaping a person's future. 教育在塑造一个人的未来方面起着至关重要的作用。
- Diet and exercise both **play a major part in** maintaining good health. 饮食和运动在保持身体健康方面都起着重要作用。

『**variety** n. 1. [C] 种类』

- Scientists discovered that this particular **variety of rabbit** (and apparently no other animal) was susceptible to a fatal virus disease, myxomatosis.
- No two sorts of birds practise quite the same sort of flight; the **varieties** are infinite; but two classes may be roughly seen.

『**variety** 2. [U] 千变万化，多样性』

- There is so much **variety** that you never have to make do with second best.
- Today, enough soundings are available to enable a relief map of the Atlantic to be drawn and we know something of the great **variety** of the sea bed's topography.

『**a variety of ...** 各种各样的』

- By comparison, trips by sea offer **a great variety of** civilized comforts.

- The museum features **a variety of** exhibits, ranging from ancient artifacts to modern art. 博物馆展出各种各样的展品，从古代文物到现代艺术应有尽有。

『 **manifest** vt. 使...显露出来；表明；显现 』

- Musical talent usually **manifests** itself in childhood.
- Social tensions often **manifest** themselves in the form of street protests. 社会紧张局势经常以街头抗议的形式显现出来。
- The disease may **manifest** through a wide range of seemingly unrelated symptoms. 这种疾病可能通过一系列看似不相关的症状表现出来。

manifest adj. 明显的；显而易见的	• Surely because progress of a particular kind is actually taking place around us and is becoming more and more **manifest**. • His lack of experience was **manifest** to everyone in the room. 他的经验不足对房间里的每个人来说都是显而易见的。

不同地理的不同风俗文化 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-16 07:22:48) 9

※ No man ever looks at the world with pristine eyes.

『 **pristine** adj. extremely clean or new 纯洁的，全新的 』

- He has **a pristine reputation**.
- The bike was **in pristine condition**.
- She viewed the ancient ruins with **pristine eyes**, as if seeing them for the first time. 她用纯净的眼睛看待这些古代遗址，仿佛是第一次看到。
- To truly appreciate art, you must try to look at it with **pristine eyes**. 要真正欣赏艺术，你必须努力用纯净的眼睛去看待它。
- The tourist was encouraged to see the landscape with **pristine eyes**, free from preconceptions. 游客被鼓励用纯净的眼睛，不受先入之见地看待风景。

※ He sees it edited by a definite set of customs and institutions and ways of thinking.

『 **institution** 1. [C] 大型机构 』

- Banks, credit unions, and insurance companies are all examples of a **financial institution**. 银行、信用合作社和保险公司都是金融机构的例子。
- The city is home to several prestigious **educational institutions**, including two major universities. 这座城市拥有几所著名的教育机构，包括两所主要大学。
- He left his entire fortune to a **charitable institution** dedicated to cancer research. 他将全部遗产留给了一家致力于癌症研究的慈善机构。

『 **institution** 2. [C] 风俗习惯 』

- Drinking tea at 4 pm is **a popular British institution**.
- He sees it edited by a definite set of **customs and institutions** and ways of thinking.他看到它被一套固定的习俗、制度和思维方式所修正。
- Changes in **customs and institutions** take generations to fully implement.习俗和制度的改变需要几代人的时间才能完全实施。
- Understanding a country requires studying its history, **customs and institutions**.了解一个国家需要研究它的历史、习俗和制度。

> As can be seen in this cartoon, a soccer player is on the point of making a penalty kick whereas a goalkeeper is preparing himself for it. Two different images pop up in their minds at the same time: the attacker is under the illusion that the goalkeeper is as big as the goal so that it is almost impossible for him to shoot in while the keeper, on the other hand, is daunted by the delusion that he turns helpless dwarf guarding a gigantic goal.
>
> The lesson we can draw from this picture is clear and simple: all too often one overestimates the challenges and difficulties he faces and underrates his capabilities to cope with them. No man ever looks at this world with pristine eyes. He sees it edited by his own feelings and ways of thinking. This is especially the case when one is at a critical time in his life. Fears and tension preoccupy him at this very moment, truth distorted and confidence destroyed.
>
> To calm his nerves and pluck up his courage, he has to realize what the truth is and admit that it is not the end of the world if he fails at this time. Then gradually, and often quite swiftly, the process of recuperation begins and a better result may be anticipated. GRE写作范例

『 **edited by** 被...所修正/筛选 』

- The historical narrative is often **edited by** the victors.历史叙事常常被胜利者所修正。
- Our perception of reality is subtly **edited by** our cultural background.我们对现实的感知被我们的文化背景巧妙地修正了。
- Every piece of data was carefully **edited by** the researchers before publication.在发表之前，每条数据都经过研究人员的仔细筛选。

『 **a definite set of** 一套明确的/固定的 』

- The experiment followed **a definite set of** procedures to ensure consistency.实验遵循一套明确的程序以确保一致性。
- Success requires adherence to **a definite set of** principles.成功需要遵守一套固定的原则。
- Each society operates under **a definite set of** rules and institutions.每个社会都在一套明确的规则和制度下运作。

※ Even in his philosophical probings he cannot go behind these stereotypes; his very concepts of the true and the false will still have reference to his particular traditional customs.

『 **probe** v. to ask questions in order to find out secret or hidden information about sb./sth. 打探， 探究，调查 』

- He didn't like the media **probing into** his past. vi.

- a TV programme that **probed** government scandals in the 1990s [vt.]

『 **stereotype** n. [C] image, idea, character, etc. that has become fixed or standardized in a conventional form without individuality 陈规，老一套，旧框框 』

- He doesn't conform to **the usual stereotype of** the city businessman with a dark suit and rolled umbrella. 他不像典型的城市商人那样，穿一身深色的西装、带一把收好的雨伞。
- They're reminded of **a positive stereotype** that boosts their morale. 他们想起了一种正面的刻板印象，从而得到了鼓舞。
- This is what psychologist, Claude Steele, described as **stereotype threat**. 这就是心理学家克劳德·斯蒂尔所描述的刻板印象威胁。
- The advertisement aims to challenge harmful gender **stereotypes**.这则广告旨在挑战有害的性别刻板印象。
- It is difficult to completely avoid the influence of cultural **stereotypes**.要完全避免文化定型观念的影响是很困难的。
- These established patterns of thinking are deeply ingrained **stereotypes**.这些既定的思维模式是根深蒂固的定型观念。

『 **prototype** n. [C] first or original example of sth. that has been or will be copied or developed; model or preliminary version 事物之原始形态，原型，雏形，模型，蓝本 』

- the **prototype** for future school buildings 未来的学校建筑的模型
- a **prototype** supersonic aircraft 超音速飞机的样机

『 **very** adj. (used to emphasize a n. 用以加强名词的语气) 』

- He knows our **very** thoughts. 他了解我们内心深处的想法。
- The **very** idea of going abroad delighted him. 他想到出国一事就很欢喜。

『 **have reference to ...** 与...有关 』

- This **has no reference to** what we were discussing.
- His very concepts of the true and the false will still **have reference to** his particular traditional customs.他关于真与假的概念仍然会参照他特定的传统习俗。
- All interpretations of the contract must **have reference to** the original text.对合同的所有解释都必须参照原文。
- The new law will primarily **have reference to** environmental protection policies.新法律将主要与环境保护政策相关。

『 **philosophical probings** 哲学探索 』

- His book is a collection of deep **philosophical probings** into the nature of existence.他的书是一系列对存在本质的深刻哲学探索。
- The debate encouraged profound **philosophical probings** among the students.这场辩论鼓励了学生们进行深刻的哲学探索。
- Throughout history, humans have engaged in **philosophical probings** to understand morality.纵观历史，人类一直致力于哲学探索以理解道德。

『 **go behind** 超越/深入追究 』

- He cannot **go behind** these stereotypes.他不能超越这些刻板印象。
- We must **go behind** the surface appearances to find the real cause of the problem.我们必须深入追究表面现象，找出问题的真正原因。
- The journalist tried to **go behind** the official statement to uncover the truth.这位记者试图深入追究官方声明，以揭露真相。

※ John Dewey has said in all seriousness that the part played by custom in shaping the behaviour of the individual, as against any way in which he can affect traditional custom, is as the proportion of the total vocabulary of his mother tongue against those words of his own baby talk that are taken up into the vernacular of his family.

『**A as against B is as C against D** A 对于 B，就如同 C 对于 D(句子的骨架结构)』

- The military power of the US, **as against** that of DPRK, is **as** the strength of an elephant **against** that of a mouse.
- In terms of speed, an email **as against** a letter **is as** a jet **against** a bicycle. 就速度而言，电子邮件之于书信，正如喷气式飞机之于自行车。
- We analyzed the number of sales this quarter **as against** the same period last year.我们分析了本季度的销售额与去年同期相比的情况。
- Their profits were high this year **as against** the disappointing results of the previous decade.他们今年的利润很高，与过去十年令人失望的结果相比。

John Dewey has said in all seriousness that... 主句引出宾语从句 (引述)			
对比项 1 (社会维度)	**主体 A**	the part played by custom in shaping the behaviour ...	(传统习俗塑造个人行为的力量)
	对手 B	**as against** any way in which he can affect custom	(对比：个人能影响传统微乎其微的方式)
is as (就好比是...)系动词 (ab的差异与cd之间的差异进行类比)			
对比项 2 (语言类比)	**主体 C**	the proportion of the total vocabulary of his mother tongue	(母语庞大的总词汇量)
	对手 D	**against** those words of his own baby talk (taken up...)	(对比：婴儿语中偶尔被家里人学去的几个词)

> **John Dewey**: American philosopher, psychologist and educator

『**take sth. ⇔ up** to accept a suggestion, offer, or idea 接受』

- Rob **took up** the invitation to visit.
- She was eager to **take up** the challenge of managing the new project. 她渴望接受管理这个新项目的挑战。
- When I **took the job** I thought I could change the system, but it's hard. 当我接受这份工作时我以为我能改变这种体制，但太难了。

take up 开始从事（兴趣、爱好、工作）	He decided to **take up** photography as a hobby during his retirement. 他决定在退休期间培养摄影这个爱好。
take up 占用（时间、空间、精力）	This old sofa **takes up** too much room in the living room. 这张旧沙发太占客厅空间了。
take up 继续（之前未完成的事）	We'll **take up** the discussion where we left off yesterday. 我们将从昨天中断的地方继续讨论。

『 **vernacular** n. [C] language or dialect spoken in a particular country or region, as compared with a formal or written language 本地话，方言土语 』

- Write a narrative descriptive passage in a vernacular other than your own. 用别人的方式写一段描述性的叙述，不是用你自己的语言。
- Certain regional phrases are taken up into the **vernacular of his family** after moving. 搬家后，某些区域性的短语被吸收到他家庭的日常用语中。
- Only a few slang terms were **taken up into the vernacular of his family**. 只有少数俚语被吸收到他家庭的日常用语中。

『 **in all seriousness** 非常认真地 』

- I tell you this **in all seriousness**. 我严肃地告诉你这事。
- I asked the question **in all seriousness**, expecting a thoughtful reply. 我非常认真地提出了这个问题，期待着深思熟虑的答复。
- The professor warned them, **in all seriousness**, about the difficulty of the final exam. 这位教授非常认真地警告了他们期末考试的难度。

※ When one seriously studies the social orders that have had the opportunity to develop autonomously, the figure becomes no more than an exact and matter-of-fact observation.

『 **autonomous** adj. 自治的，独立的 』

- They proudly declared themselves part of a new **autonomous** province.
- He treated us as **autonomous** individuals who had to learn to make up our own minds about important issues.
- The remote team was allowed to **develop autonomously**, without constant micromanagement. 这个远程团队被允许自主发展，没有持续的微观管理。

- The research facility must **develop autonomously** to ensure unbiased findings.研究设施必须自主发展，以确保公正的发现。

『 **figure** n. figure of speech 比喻修辞 』

- 'Get up with the lark' is **a figure (of speech)**, meaning 'Get out of bed early'.
- Antithesis is **a figure of speech** in rhetoric. 对照是修辞学中的一个修辞格。
- Think "broken heart" is just **a figure of speech**? Think again. 觉得"心碎"只是一个比喻修辞说法?

『 **no more than** =only 只不过 』

- It will take **no more than** five days to read the book.
- It's **no more than** a misunderstanding.
- The error turned out to be **no more than** a simple typo in the code.这个错误结果只不过是代码中的一个简单错字。
- His contribution was **no more than** a minor suggestion at the start of the project.他的贡献只不过是项目开始时的一个微小建议。

『 **matter-of-fact** adj. showing no emotion when you are talking about sth. exciting, frightening, upsetting etc. 不带个人情感的 』

- She told us the news of his death in a very **matter-of-fact** way.
- He was very **matter-of-fact** about the breakdown of his marriage.

『 **observation** n. remark or comment 言语，评论 』

- She made one or two **observations** about the weather. 评论
- The witness gave a calm and **matter-of-fact observation** of the incident.这位目击者对事件作了平静而实事求是的观察。
- Her report was simply a **matter-of-fact observation** of the experimental results, devoid of interpretation.她的报告只是对实验结果的实事求是的观察，没有解读。

※ The life history of the individual is first and foremost an accommodation to the patterns and standards traditionally handed down in his community.

『 **first and foremost** more than anything else, firstly and most importantly 首要地，主要 』

- He does a bit of writing, but **first and foremost** he's a teacher.
- **First and foremost**, we have to consider the morality of the enterprise.
- Our priority is **first and foremost** the safety of our customers.我们的首要任务首先是客户的安全。
- As a teacher, her job is **first and foremost** to inspire curiosity.作为一名教师，她的工作首先是激发好奇心。

『 **accommodation to sth.** 对...的适应 』

- the **accommodation** of my plans **to** yours
- Living abroad requires a significant **accommodation to** new social norms.在国外生活需要对新的社会规范进行重大的适应。

- The new software required a rapid **accommodation to** its changed interface.新软件需要快速适应其改变后的界面。
- **Accommodation to** a different culture can take several months. 适应一种不同的文化可能需要几个月的时间。

accommodate to sth. v. 适应...；顺应...	• Her eyes took a while to **accommodate to** the darkness. • Students must **accommodate** themselves **to** the new school environment. 学生们必须使自己适应新的学校环境。

『 **hand sth. down** pass sth. from older people to younger ones The recipe was handed down from an ancestor of the family. 』

- The only way that they can preserve their history is to recount it as sagas—legends **handed down** from one generation of storytellers to another.
- The techniques for crafting the pottery were **traditionally handed down** from master to apprentice.制作陶器的技术是传统上传承下来的，从师傅传给学徒。

『 **community** n. a group of people who have the same interests, religion, race etc. 集体，群体 』

- He's well liked by people **in the community**.他很受社区人们的喜爱。
- The whole **community** was aroused by the crime.这个罪行使整个社会行动起来。
- The residents formed **a community** action group.居民组成了社区行动组。
- We have good contacts with the **local community.**我们与当地社区关系甚好。

※ From the moment of his birth, the customs into which he is born shape his experience and behaviour.

『 **be born into** 出生于...（某种家庭背景、社会阶层或环境） 』

- He was **born into** a wealthy family with a long history of political influence. 他出生在一个有着悠久政治影响力的富有家庭。
- Understanding **the customs into which he is born** is key to understanding the individual.理解他出生的习俗是理解这个个体的关键。
- She **was born into** a very musical family. 她生于音乐之家。

『 **shape** v.塑造...；决定...的形成 』

- Early childhood experiences often **shape** a person's character for life. 童年早期的经历往往会塑造一个人一生的性格。
- Education and environment profoundly **shape his experience and behaviour** throughout life.教育和环境深刻地塑造了他一生中的经验和行为。

shape sth. into sth. 将某物捏成/造成某形状	The artist **shaped** the clay **into** a beautiful vase. 艺术家把粘土捏成了一个精美的花瓶。

※ By the time he can talk, he is the little creature of his culture, and by the time he is grown and able to take part in its activities, its habits are his habits, its beliefs ~~(are)~~ his beliefs, its impossibilities ~~(are)~~ his impossibilities.

『 **creature** n. someone who is controlled or influenced a lot by sth. 产物，奴隶，傀儡 』

- a **creature of** habit
- He is **a creature of** the government.
- Every student, to some extent, is **a little creature of** his culture, reflecting its values and biases.每个学生在某种程度上都是他文化的产物，反映着它的价值观和偏见。

creature n. 受他人/环境支配的人；傀儡；产物	The dictator was seen by many as a **creature** of the foreign government. 许多人认为那个独裁者只是外国政府的傀儡。
a creature of habit 凭习惯行事的人	I'm **a creature of habit**; I always have my coffee at exactly 7:00 AM. 我是一个生活非常有规律的人；我总是准时在早上7点喝咖啡。
a creature of... ...的产物/奴隶	Man is often a **creature** of his environment. 人往往是环境的产物。

※ Every child that is born into his group will share them with him, and no child born into one on the opposite side of the globe can ever achieve the thousandth part.

『 **be born in / into ...** 出生于（某种环境、背景或阶层） 』

- I **was born in** Tokyo.
- Meg **was born into** a large family.
- She was **born into** a musical family and started playing piano at age four. 她出生在一个音乐世家，四岁就开始弹钢琴。
- A person **born into his group** inherits a specific social status and network.出生在他的群体中的人继承了特定的社会地位和人脉。

be born in ... 出生于（具体的时间或地点）	He was **born in** 1986 in a small coastal town. 他于1986年出生在一个沿海小镇。

『 **share** v. to have the same opinion, quality, or experience as sb. else 有一样的，有共同的 』

- I believe my view is **widely shared**.
- In some moods, Nature **shares** it.

『 **share sth. with sb.** 与某人分享/共用某物 』

- I **shared** my umbrella **with** a stranger in the pouring rain. 我在倾盆大雨中与一个陌生人共用一把伞。
- He refused to **share** the information **with** the police. 他拒绝向警方透露（分享）这些信息。
- People often **share** their political views **with** their parents.

- Stubbornness was a characteristic he **shared with** his mother.
- The children will **share the traditions with him** as they grow older.孩子们长大后会与他分享这些传统。

※ There is no social problem (which) it is more incumbent upon us to understand than this of the role of custom.

『**social problem** 社会问题』

- Homelessness remains a pressing **social problem** in major cities.无家可归仍然是主要城市中一个紧迫的社会问题。
- The government established a task force to tackle the root causes of the **social problem**.政府成立了一个工作组来解决这个社会问题的根源。

『**it is incumbent upon / on sb. to do sth.** 某人有责任/义务做某事』

- It is **incumbent upon** parents to control what their children watch on TV.
- There is no ethical dilemma **it is more incumbent upon us to address than** this of data privacy.没有哪个伦理困境比数据隐私更需要我们去解决。
- There is no task **it is more incumbent upon us to complete than** this crucial system upgrade.没有哪个任务比这次关键的系统升级更需要我们去完成。

※ Until we are intelligent as to its laws and varieties, the main complicating facts of human life must remain unintelligible.

『**intelligent** adj. showing powers of understanding 能够理解的，了解的』

- The vast majority of us are not **intelligent** about the whole thing.
- We must become **intelligent as to** the new regulations before proceeding.在进行之前，我们必须对新法规有所认识。
- The team needs to be **intelligent as to** the competitive landscape before launching the product.在推出产品之前，团队需要对竞争格局有所深入了解。

『**as to prep. = about = with regard to** 关于，对于』

- He was uncertain **as to** which road to take.
- We are puzzled **as to** how it happened.
- There is no doubt **as to** his ability to do the job. 对于他胜任这项工作的能力，毋庸置疑。

『**unintelligible** adj. impossible to understand 不可能理解的，难懂的』

- What he said was completely **unintelligible** to me because he used many technical terms.
- Without the decryption key, the encrypted message **must remain unintelligible**.没有解密密钥，加密信息必定仍然难以理解。
- He answered in words **unintelligible** to her. 他用她听不懂的话来回答。
- The terms were **unintelligible** to ordinary folk . 这些术语一般人是不懂的。

作者主张的观点 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-16 10:30:23) 5

※ The study of custom can be profitable only after certain preliminary propositions have been accepted, and some of these propositions have been violently opposed.

『 **preliminary** adj. coming before a more important action or event, preparatory 开端的，初步的，预备性的 』

- **After a few preliminary remarks** about the weather, the speaker dove straight into the main topic. 在说了几句关于天气的开场白之后，演讲者直接进入了正题。
- The preliminary experiments showed **promising** inquiries / experiments / negotiations, but more testing is needed. 初步调查 / 实验 / 谈判显示出了令人满意的结果，但仍需进一步测试。
- She performed exceptionally well in **the preliminary contest** and moved on to the finals. 她在预赛中表现异常出色，顺利晋级决赛。
- The team must agree on **the preliminary propositions** before starting the complex analysis. 团队必须在开始复杂的分析之前就初步命题达成一致。
- We spent the morning discussing **the preliminary propositions** that form the basis of the research. 我们花了一个上午讨论构成研究基础的初步命题。

『 **proposition** n. statement that expresses a judgement or an opinion, assertion 观点，见解，主张 』

- The **proposition** is so clear that it needs no explanation.
- I approve of the **proposition** that love alone can waken love.
- As a business **proposition**, it's a non-starter. 作为一份商业建议，它不可能取得成功。

『 **profitable** adj.有益的/有利可图的 』

- Investing in renewable energy has proven to be a **profitable** long-term strategy. 投资可再生能源已被证明是一个有利可图的长期战略。
- Sharing knowledge and resources makes the collaboration more **profitable** for everyone involved. 分享知识和资源使协作对所有参与者更有益。
- The **production** of coffee beans is a huge, profitable business. 咖啡豆的生产是一项庞大且有利可图的业务。

※ In the first place, any scientific study requires that there (should) be no preferential weighting of one or another of the items in the series it selects for its consideration.

『 **in the first place** 首先/第一点；起初（常用于解释原因或列举理由） 』

- **In the first place**, I'm too busy, and in the second, I don't really want to go.
- **In the first place**, we need to secure funding before hiring more staff. 首先，我们需要在招聘更多员工之前确保资金到位。

- I should never have taken that job **in the first place**. 我起初（从一开始）就不该接受那份工作。

First / Firstly 首先；第一（用于正式列举步骤或论点）	**Firstly**, we must consider the budget; secondly, the timeline. 首先，我们必须考虑预算；其次，是时间表。
First of all 首先；第一（比 firstly 语气更强，更口语化）	**First of all**, I'd like to thank everyone for coming today. 首先，我想感谢大家今天的到来。
To begin with / To start with 首先；第一（常用于列举一系列原因中的第一个）	The hotel was terrible. **To begin with**, the room was tiny. 这家旅店太差了。首先，房间非常小。

『 **preferential** adj. of, giving, receiving or showing preference 优先的，给予优先的，得到优先的，优待的 』

- Europe has given Caribbean banana growers **preferential** treatment for more than 20 years.
- Firstborn sons received **preferential** treatment. 长子们受到了优等待遇。
- He had promised that the rich and privileged would no longer get **preferential** treatment. 他已承诺富人和特权阶层将不会再得到优待。

『 **weight** vt. [esp passive 尤用於被动语态] plan or organize (sth.) in a way that favours a particular person or group, bias 计划或组织（某事物）使之偏向某人或某集体，使偏袒 』

- a law **weighted against** those owning land 对土地持有者不利的法规
- a law **weighted in favour** of those owning land 对土地持有者偏袒的法规
- Fair judgment requires that there be no preferential **weighting** given to personal relationships.公正的评判要求不对私人关系给予偏袒性的权重。

※ In all the less controversial fields, like the study of cacti or termites or the mature of nebulae, the necessary method of study is to group the relevant material and to take note of all possible variant forms and conditions.

『 **group** v. to make sb./sth. form a group 使聚集，汇集 』

- The children **grouped** themselves around their teacher.
- All the multiple choice questions will **be grouped** together for convenience.
- Categories can be used to **group** or sort result sets. 可以使用目录对结果集进行分组或排序。

『 **take note of sth. = pay attention to sth. = take notice of sth.** 注意 ...；留意（常指记在脑子里或纸上） 』

- People were beginning to **take note of** her talents as a writer.
- Please **take note of** the revision to the schedule. 请留意时间表的修订。

pay attention to sth. 注意；留心（强调专注力或听从建议）	You need to **pay attention to** the details if you want to pass the exam. 如果你想通过考试，你需要注意细节。

take notice of sth. 注意到；理会（常用于否定句，表示"不在意"）	I hope they'll **take notice of** what I'm saying. 我希望他们能理会我所说的话。

『 **variant** adj. having or exhibiting variation; differing 相异的，不同的 』

- a **variant form** of the word
- a **variant form** of oxygen known as ozone
- Test cases are a **variant** subset of upstream testing. 测试用例是上游测试的不同子集。

『 **variant** n. [C] sth. which is slightly different from other similar things 变种，变体 』

- There are many colas on the market now, all **variants on** the original drink.
- There are four **variants of** malaria, all transmitted to humans by a particular family of mosquitoes.
- It is crucial for field biologists to take note of all possible **variant forms** and conditions of the local ecosystem. 对于野外生物学家来说，注意到当地生态系统的所有可能的变异形式和条件至关重要。

variant of ... ...的变体；...的一种形式	This new model is a **variant of** the original design. 这款新模型是原始设计的一种变体。
variant on ... 在...基础上的变体/改动	The recipe is a delicious **variant on** the traditional apple pie. 这道菜谱是在传统苹果派基础上的一种美味变体。

※ In this way, we have learned all that we know of the laws of astronomy, or of the habits of the social insects, let us say.

『 **(let us) say** for example 比如说，例如 』

- To see the problem here more clearly, let's look at a different biological system, **(let us) say**, an acorn.
- The Americans would happily reach one accord on standards for medical devices and then hammer out different pacts covering, **say**, electronic goods and drug manufacturing.
- The project will require a large investment, **let us say**, around ten million dollars. 这个项目将需要一大笔投资，比如，大约一千万美元。

※ It is only in the study of man himself that the major social sciences have substituted the study of one local variation, that of Western civilization.

> It is only in the study of man himself that the major social sciences have **substituted** the study of one local variation, that of Western civilization, ~~(for the study of custom of all human beings)~~. 补全 (substitute A for B)

『 **substitute A for B** 用 A 代替 B 』

- You can **substitute** honey **for** sugar in this recipe. 在这份食谱中，你可以用蜂蜜代替白糖。
- The company has **substituted** the study of user feedback **for** reliance on internal assumptions. 该公司已用用户反馈的研究来代替对内部假设的依赖。
- You can **substitute** chicken **for** beef if you don't like red meat.

replace B with A 用 A 替换 B	• You can **replace** beef **with** chicken if you don't like red meat. • I need to **replace** the old battery **with** a new one. 我需要用新电池替换掉旧电池。

作者主张的结语 (笔记最后修改于:2026-04-16 11:17:07) 6

※ Anthropology was by definition impossible, as long as these distinctions between ourselves and the primitive, ourselves and the barbarian, ourselves and the pagan, held sway over people's minds.

『 **by definition** if sth. has a particular quality by definition, it must have that quality because all things of that type have it 从本质上来说;根据定义/本质上 』

- People say that students are **by definition** idealistic and impatient.
- Human perception is highly imperfect and **by definition** subjective.
- A square is **by definition** a rectangle with four equal sides. 一个正方形根据定义就是四条边相等的矩形。
- Fraud is **by definition** a deliberate deception to secure unfair or unlawful gain. 欺诈本质上是为了获得不公平或非法的利益而进行的蓄意欺骗。

『 **hold sway** to be the main influence on people's opinions or behavior 占主导地位(书面语) 』

- The traditional idea of wearing new clothes on New Year's day seems no longer to **hold sway**.
- For decades, the ideology of the ruling party **held sway** over people's minds. 几十年来，执政党的意识形态一直支配着人们的思想。
- Superstition often **holds sway** over people's minds in times of uncertainty. 在不确定时期，迷信往往会支配人们的思想。

※ It was necessary first to arrive at that degree of sophistication where we no longer set our own belief against our neighbour's superstition.

『 **set ... against ...** make sb. oppose or be hostile to (a friend, relative, etc) 使某人反对或敌视（朋友、亲戚等） 』

- The civil war **set** brother **against** brother.
- She accused her husband of **setting** their children **against** her.

- It is counterproductive to **set** our own methods **against** those of the new team members.将我们自己的方法与新团队成员的方法对立起来是事与愿违的。

『**arrive at** 达到/得出（结论、理解）』

- After hours of discussion, the committee was finally able to **arrive at** a consensus.经过数小时的讨论，委员会最终能够达成共识。
- Go straight on, and in the evening you will **arrive at** a castle. 一直往前走，傍晚时你就会到达一座城堡。
- Put a deadline on the input stage and **arrive at** a decision, even if it's a decision that doesn't have consensus. 你要在输入阶段设定一个最后期限并作出决定，即使这个决定没有达成共识。
- We use information that we perceive through our senses to help us make decisions, to **arrive at** beliefs and so on. 我们利用我们通过感官感知到的信息来帮助我们做决定，达成信念等等。

※ It was necessary to recognize that these institutions which are based on the same premises, let us say the supernatural, must be considered together, our own among the rest.

『**premise** n. statement or idea on which reasoning is based, hypothesis（推理所依据的）前提， 假定』

- Advice to investors was based on **the premise** that interest rates would continue to fall.
- Which **premise** would you reject? 你们反对哪个前提?
- That's the crucial **premise**. 这是个很关键的前提。
- We might need a suppressed **premise**. 我们可能需要一个隐含的前提。

『**supernatural** adj. that cannot be explained by natural or physical laws 超自然的』

- **supernatural** beings, eg angels and devils
- witch-doctors believed to have **supernatural** powers
- Small wonder that an Indian legend described Devils Tower as being formed by **supernatural powers.** 难怪印度传说中魔鬼塔是由超自然力量形成的。

> our own (being) among the rest 独立主语

『**be among ...** 是...之一；包括在...之中』

- He **was among** the last to leave.
- **Among** those present **were** the Prime Minister and her husband.
- These ocean waves **are among** the earth's most complicated natural phenomena.
- The committee reviewed all proposals, our own **among** the rest, to ensure impartiality. 委员会审查了所有提案，包括我们自己的在内，以确保公正性。



Old habits die hard

江山易改本性难移

Idioms

请发送邮件至 hibenba@gmail.com 或直接访问官网 (**ncego.com**) 提交错误举报。

“一场孤独的修行，需要相信积累的力量。专注当下、珍惜时间、顶峰相见。”